

Eighteenth International Linguistics Olympiad

Ventspils (Latvia), 19–23 July 2021

Individual Contest Solutions

Problem 3.

- Word order:
 - V(O)S (V = verb; O = object; S = subject)
 - QVX (Q = interrogative element)
 - (*which* | Qt)N(D)(A) (Qt = quantity, N = noun, D = demonstrative pronouns, A = adjective)

- verb:

- **le-** past
- **bi-** future
- **-si** subject = plural (**-gisi-si** > **-gisesi**)

- noun:

	singular	plural
<i>man</i>	tau	tauwau
<i>child</i>	gwadi	gugwadi
<i>chief</i>	guyau	gweguyau
<i>old woman</i>	namwaya	nunumwaya
~	singular = plural	

- class (Cl):

- men: **te-** (before Qt); **to-**
- women/animals: **na-**
- children: **gudi-**
- canoes: **ke-**
- things (for example stones): **kwe-**

- demonstrative pronouns: (**a-**)**ma-Cl(-si)(-we)-na**, **ma-to-** > **mto-**, **ma-na-** > **mina-**

- quantity: Cl-**vila** *how many?*, Cl-**tala** 1, Cl-**yu** 2, Cl-**vasi** 4

- (b) 19. *How many canoes did those old women see?*

Kevila waga legisesi nunumwaya minasiwena?

20. *These four white men will look after this clever child.*

Biyamatasi gwadi magudina gudikabitam tevasi dimdim mtosina.

21. *How many children will eat these pigs?*

Gudivila gugwadi bikamkwamsi bunukwa minasina?

22. *Which woman caught those beautiful fish?*

Aminana vivila lebani yena minasiwena namanabweta?

23. *Two wild dogs saw that old man.*

Legisesi tomwaya mtowena nayu ka'ukwa nagasisi.

- (a) 14. **Navila vivila biyamata tomwaya mtona?**

How many women will this old man look after?

15. **Bikamkwamsi kweyu vivila minasina.**

These women will eat two things.

16. **Amagudina gwadi lekota?**

Which child arrived?

17. **Tevila tauwau bigisesi gugwadi gudigasisi?**

How many men will see the wild children?;

How many men will the wild children see?

18. **Legisesi ketala waga vivila minasiwena.**

Those women saw one canoe.